

their source code, and user groups such as SHARE were formed to facilitate the sharing and exchange of IBM 701 source code.

However, by the late 1960s with the evolution of high level languages and operating systems, software development costs were increasing. While most earlier software had been bundled with the hardware it was meant to be used on, there was software in the market that was exclusively for sale only.

Some programs such as Unix were given free of cost to academia and related users by AT&T, but in the absence of the permission to modify and redistribute, this was hardly open source.

Soon, by the 1970s, there were exclusive software-only companies selling software with licences that forbade modification and redistribution through patents, copyrights and trademarks. By the 1980s, nothing was left of free software as known till then. Even Unix was marketed commercially, and open source was dead.

In 1983, Richard Stallman of MIT was annoyed at Symbolics Inc. for not allowing modifications to updates on its LISP machines based on MIT's code and started the GNU project. The GNU project aimed at creating a UNIX-like open source operating system free from regulations preventing it from being modified and redistributed.

The GNU project is also aimed at creating open source development tools such as compilers and libraries. This is the beginning of modern open source as we know it, though the term 'open source' wouldn't come into existence for another 15 years. Around the same time, Stallman also founded the free software foundation that coined the free software definition – a precursor to the open source definition.



GNU

**GNU is a
recursive
acronym for
GNU's not
Unix**